

Living Standards in Nazi Germany

Big companies ⇒ benefitted the most from Nazi rule

→ no longer had to worry about strikes and trade unions

Companies like ⇒ Siemens, Mercedes, Volkswagen ⇒ made massive profits from govt contracts.

as companies flourished ⇒ so did their managers.

→ their incomes rose much faster than those of their workers

Farmers

During great depression ⇒ Many farmers ⇒ borrowed money to survive ⇒ and were in debt ⇒ esp. with banks.

Introduction of *Reich Entailed Farm Law* ⇒ made it impossible to take land owned by farmers in debt and force them out

⇒ saved many farmers from losing farms

However ⇒ farms were not owned by state ⇒ and many farmers still remained poor.

Middle Classes

Many middle class Germans ⇒ pleased at the crushing of communists.

Owners of businesses ⇒ connected to rearmament ⇒ benefitted from govt contracts.

Many small businesses ⇒ found it difficult to do well in prevailing economic conditions
